WSC 2016 Open Forum question for The Franny

I'm an addict. My name is Tom. Hi everybody. Welcome to all of the visitors from out of the United States, for participating from nations outside of the United States. <Where are you from?> I am from the Show Me Region, Jefferson City, Missouri. And my question is for the World Board because this is the only place I can get an answer.

I was a participant on a Facebook Group WSC 2016. And somebody had posted this on there and it was a request, it says March the 30th sent to the office, I would like to request time on the agenda at the upcoming WSC schedule for to seek resolution to a conflict concerning the use of NA Intellectual Property rights by individuals and service entities within the NA Fellowship and enforcement actions taken by the World Board as trustees of the intellectual property trust.

From my reading of the NA Intellectual Property Trust Bulletin #5, I believe I have the right to request that this conflict be resolved at the upcoming WSC. That conflict is the decision by the board to, what in my mind, is violate our first tradition by causing disunity and pitting addict against addict. On the FIPT trust issue, that you guys are according to the FIPT are supposed to resolve. Instead of resolving it you are trying to get NA members to take on NA members. And I think that is completely wrong. And it is spelled out in the FIPT, the very last page of Bulletin #6, that you have a right to request time at this conference to confront that issue that conflict that you guys seem to be creating in my mind. And it is the place to be resolve. You have a right to request time at this conference to confront this issue conflict you are. The conflict request was denied. So there is no time on the WCS schedule permitted by your decision, your choice. So you are again neglecting the responsibility of the FITP Bulletin #5, Item #6 and you are not fulfilling your obligation under the FIPT, section operational rules, article 4, section 11. It tells you exactly what you are supposed to do if somebody is violating the FIPT. And nowhere in there does it say you are supposed to pit member against member. So how can you guys say I don't have the right--or this person doesn't have the right--to request time on this floor.

Thank you for your question, Tom. First of all I am going to say that Facebook is not a presence that the Narcotics Anonymous World Services or the World Board is involved in. Some members are on Facebook, but we do not as a board respond collectively respond to any Facebook inquiry. We understand the inquiry came in from email. Also it was not sent in by a regional delegate, nor was it a motion by a region, nor was it anything that came with any of the voting or deciding members of this body. When an individual sends a request in, we discuss it and we determine whether or not it appears that the rest of the conference participants had had an opportunity to consider it in their home communities and whether or not those communities supported moving it forward. The place to move things forward from regions to the conference is three fold. We have Conference Agenda Report. We have inquires through the emails. We have the Conference report, presently. We are looking into further discussion opportunities and mechanisms in which to invite those things into the consideration track. But presently unless an RD brings a motion forward, it will not make time for the conference consideration.

I disagree with your interpretation of the FIPT. I am going to invite some other board members to address that. It doesn't mean that I am right and you wrong. It means that I disagree. And most of these things are arguably up for interpretation. So, if someone else wants to address.

<WOMAN:> What I would like to address is the question of whether this conference or service conference 2016 will have the opportunity to discuss the issues involved in the FIPT. And if you look at your schedule, you know you have great opportunity. And we want this discussion to take place. And it will take place. So it is not being the opportunity to discuss it is being facilitated, not denied.

<I have another question over here.>